



2 for the price of 4?

Audi has unveiled a sporting bicycle in Japan, priced at \$19,650.
<http://digit.in/1QZJhGx>



Snazzy Apple

Apple is now selling a lightning dock for the iPhone 6 and 6 Plus:
<http://digit.in/1HezsgS>



DIY: RC Helicopter

DO you want to build an RC helicopter? Did you think it was too hard?
 This article will set your thoughts straight.

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If you're a geek worth his salt, chances are high that you may have dabbled with radio-controlled (RC) vehicles at some point in the past. It's hard to resist a hobby encapsulating the best of electronic and mechanical engineering in a package that appeals to our innate love of toys. Not surprisingly, almost everyone showing up in the market for an RC helicopter invariably ends up buying cheap, toy-grade ones. Unfortunately, these cut-price Chinese offerings use cheap motors that are slow, inefficient, and don't usually last more than a few dozen flights.

Hobby-grade RC helicopters are expensive because almost half of the cost can be attributed to import duties. Prima facie, spending tens of thousands of rupees on hobby-grade versions seems to be the only

way to ensure sophistication and reliability. Unless, of course, you happen to be an intrepid geek willing to get his hands dirty with a screwdriver and soldering iron to build a hobby-grade RC helicopter. If you're smart about where and how you import the constituent parts, it's easy to escape ridiculous import duties and build an RC helicopter at a bargain.

When in Doubt, DIY

This is exactly what we are going to achieve with this DIY guide. However, instead of providing a blueprint specific to any particular RC helicopter model, this guide aims to prime the reader on how to choose the right components along with a templatised step-by-step assembly guide, common to all single-rotor electric helicopters. This doesn't cover nitro/petrol-powered or quad-rotor helicopters. The former for obvious reasons and the latter because quadcopters are about as

manoeuvrable and fun to fly as tractors.

The guide also excludes coaxial or larger outdoor helicopters because these alternatives represent the two extremes of the cost spectrum. The idea is to avoid platforms that are ridiculously cheap and simple or outrageously expensive and complicated. Although we have narrowed down our project size to the category of a single-rotor micro RC helicopter, it still contains a baffling array of choices that are best tackled once we break down the basic constituent parts of an RC helicopter and understand their functions.

What Makes a Helicopter Tick?

(1) Canopy: The lightweight outer body shell that protects the delicate innards and improves aerodynamics. **(2) Frame:** Made from either fibre-reinforced plastic or carbon fibre, the frame forms the skeleton that houses sensitive electronics as